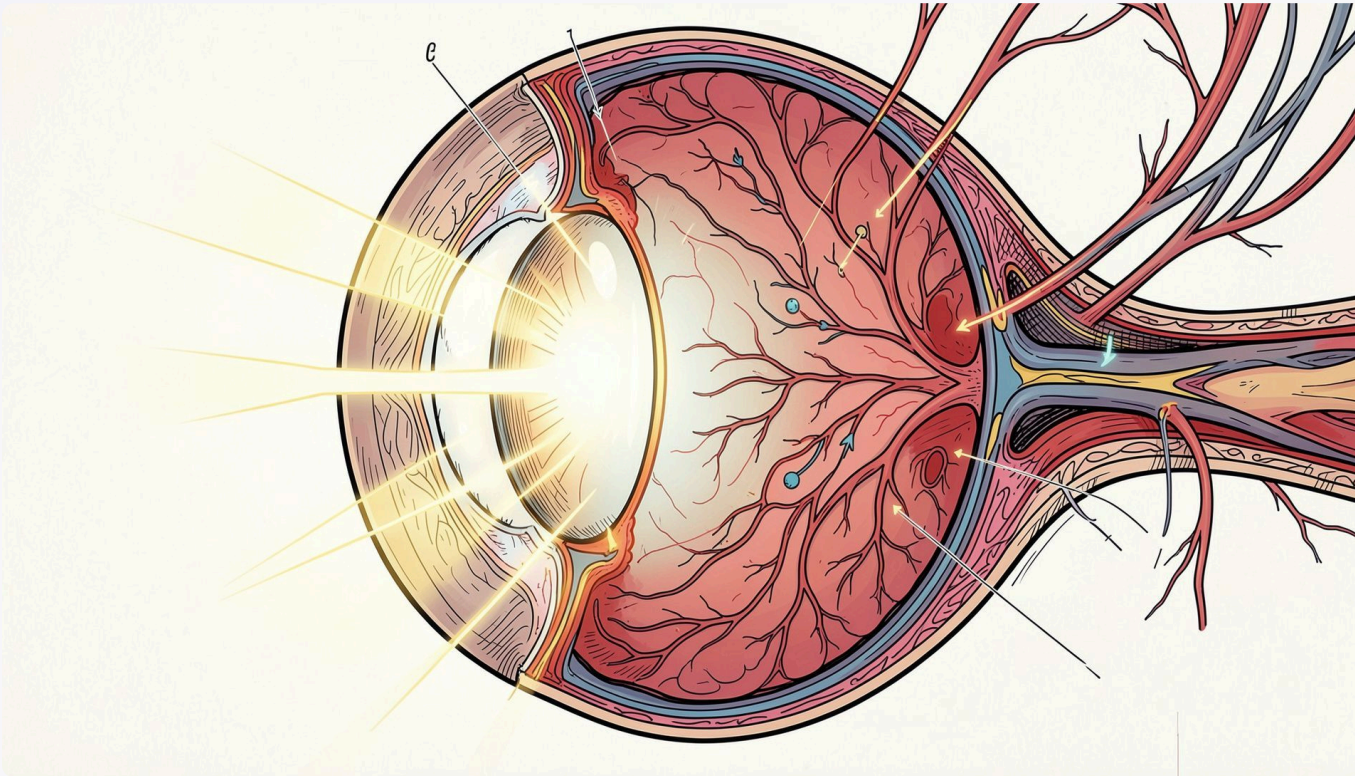




Glaucoma: The Silent Thief of Sight

Glaucoma can damage your vision gradually — without obvious warning signs. By the time you notice symptoms, the damage may already be done.

What Is Glaucoma?



Glaucoma is a group of eye diseases that damage the **optic nerve** — the nerve that carries visual information from the eye to the brain.

- ❑ Measuring eye pressure alone is **not enough** to diagnose glaucoma.

Increased eye pressure

A key risk factor — but not the only one.

Normal pressure glaucoma

Can also occur when eye pressure is in the normal range.

Why "Silent Thief"?

1

Early Stage

No noticeable symptoms — vision appears normal.

2

Progression

Vision loss begins at the **peripheral or side vision**, often unnoticed.

3

Advanced Stage

Untreated glaucoma can cause **severe, permanent vision loss**.

Waiting for symptoms is **not** a reliable way to detect glaucoma.



Who Is at Greater Risk?

Anyone can develop glaucoma, but certain factors increase the risk. People with significant risk factors may need more frequent and comprehensive eye examinations.



Age

Risk increases with age.



Family History

Genetics play a significant role.



African Ancestry

Higher risk, particularly at younger ages.



High Eye Pressure

A key contributing factor.



Medical Conditions

Certain conditions can increase risk.

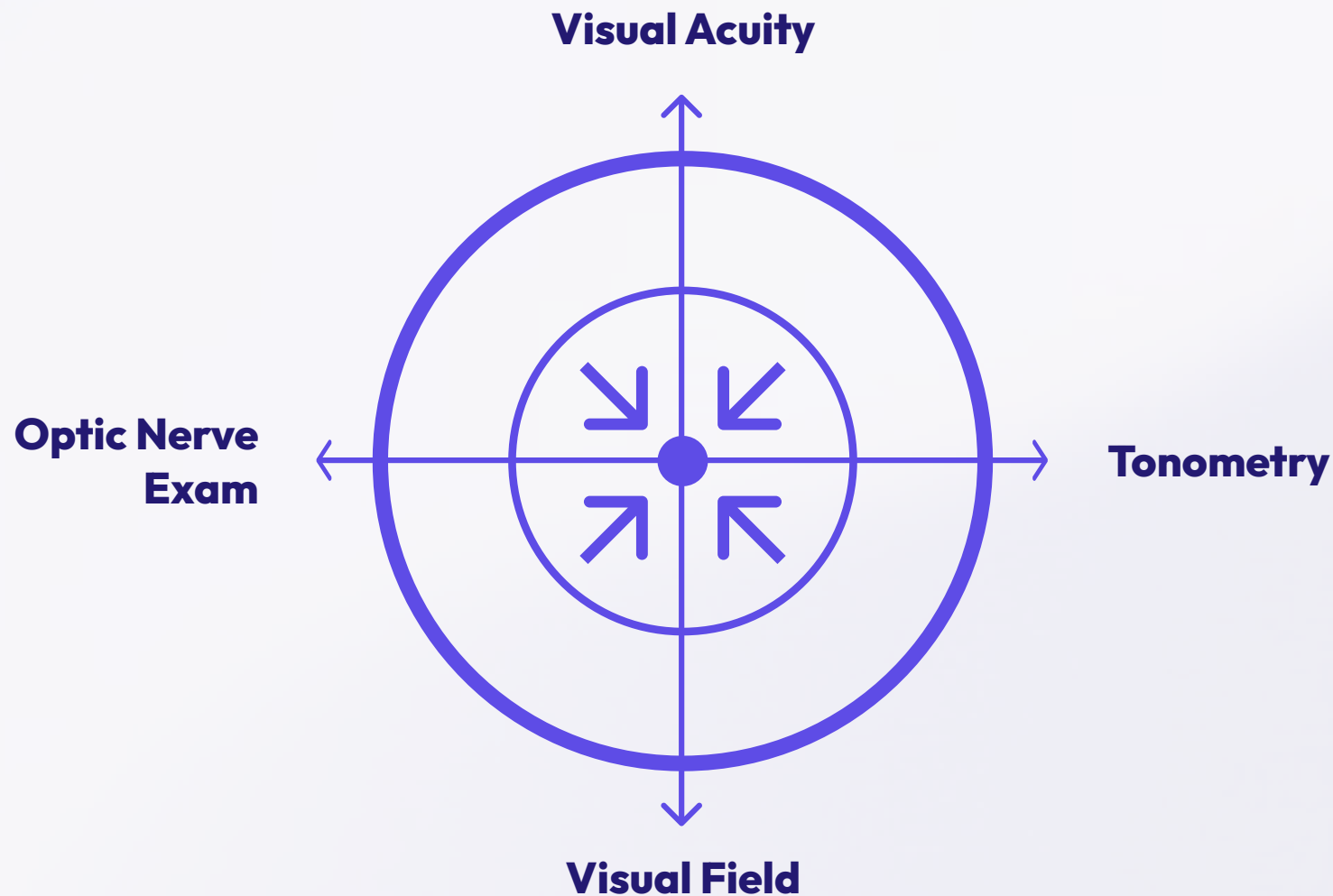


Eye Injury or Medications

Previous injury or prolonged corticosteroid use.

How Is Glaucoma Detected?

A **comprehensive eye examination** is essential. Your eye-care professional may perform several tests depending on your individual situation.



These tests work together to assess your eye health and identify signs of glaucoma — no single test is sufficient on its own.

Understanding the Diagnostic Tests

1

Visual Acuity Testing

Measures how clearly you can see at different distances.

2

Tonometry

Measures pressure inside the eye — but pressure alone doesn't confirm or rule out glaucoma.

3

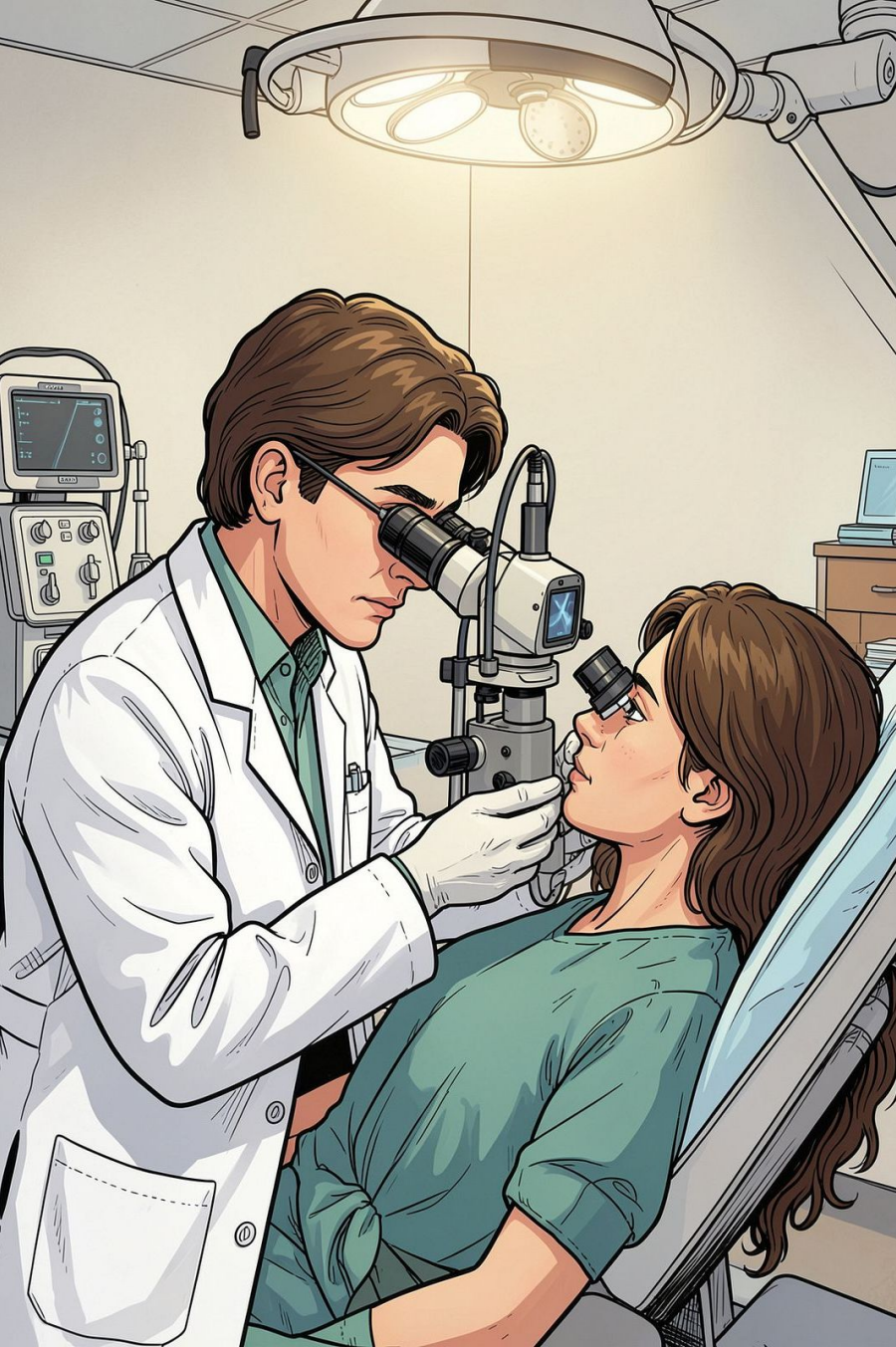
Visual Field Testing

Evaluates peripheral vision and identifies areas of vision loss you may not have noticed.

4

Dilated Eye Examination

Dilating the pupils allows a closer look at the optic nerve and structures at the back of the eye.



Can Glaucoma Be Treated?

There is currently **no cure** that reverses optic nerve damage — but **early diagnosis and treatment can slow or stop further vision loss.**

Eye Drops

Prescription drops to reduce eye pressure.

Laser Treatment

Targeted laser therapy for certain types of glaucoma.

Surgery

Procedures to improve fluid drainage when other treatments aren't sufficient.

Can Glaucoma Be Prevented?



There is currently **no guaranteed way** to prevent glaucoma. However, **regular comprehensive eye examinations** are one of the most important ways to detect the disease early — before significant vision loss occurs.

- ❏ This is especially important if you have a **family history of glaucoma** or are at increased risk due to age.

Early detection gives your eye-care professional the best chance to protect your remaining vision.

Don't Wait for Symptoms

Feel fine? That's the danger.

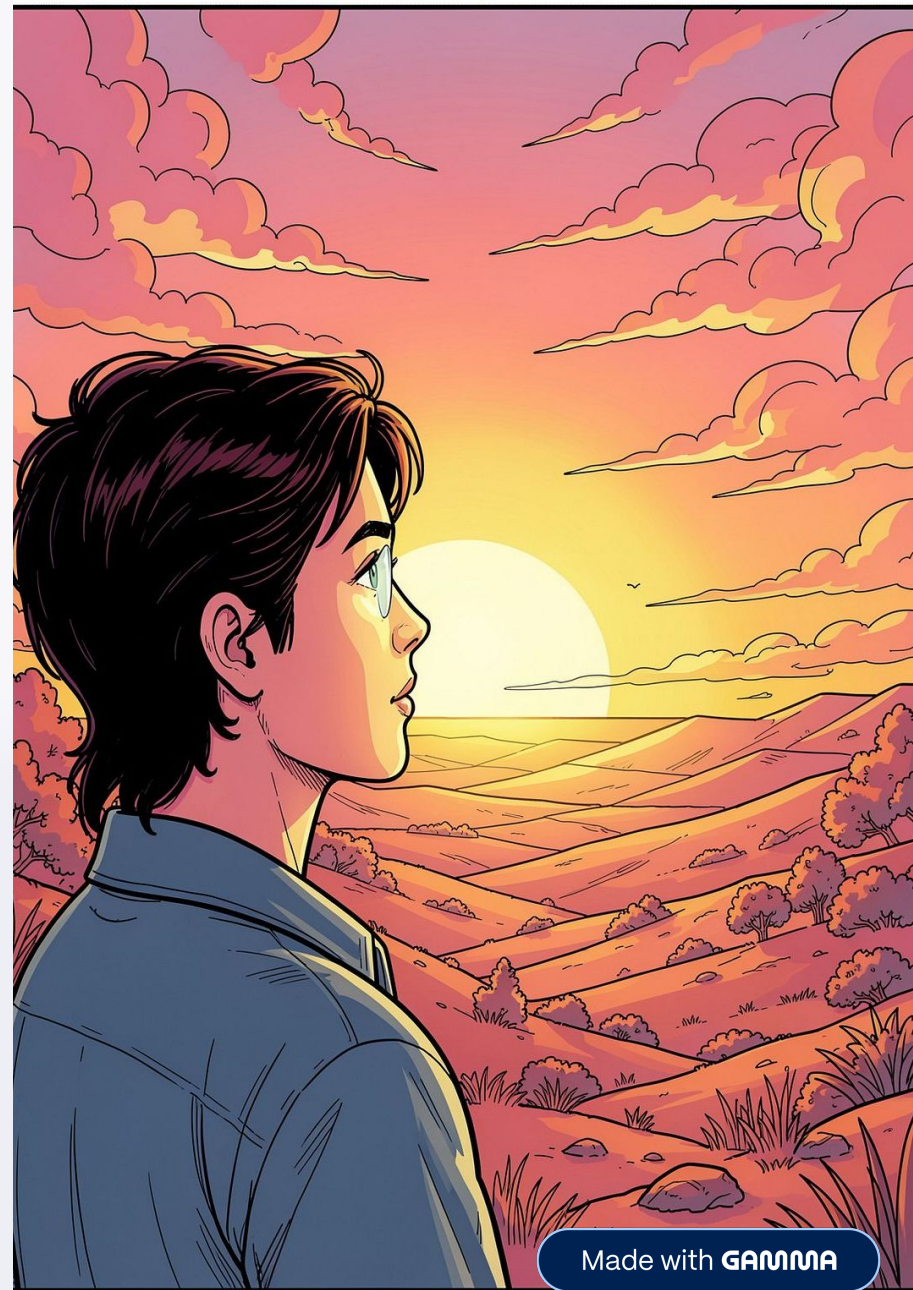
One of the most dangerous things about glaucoma is that you may feel perfectly fine while the disease is developing.

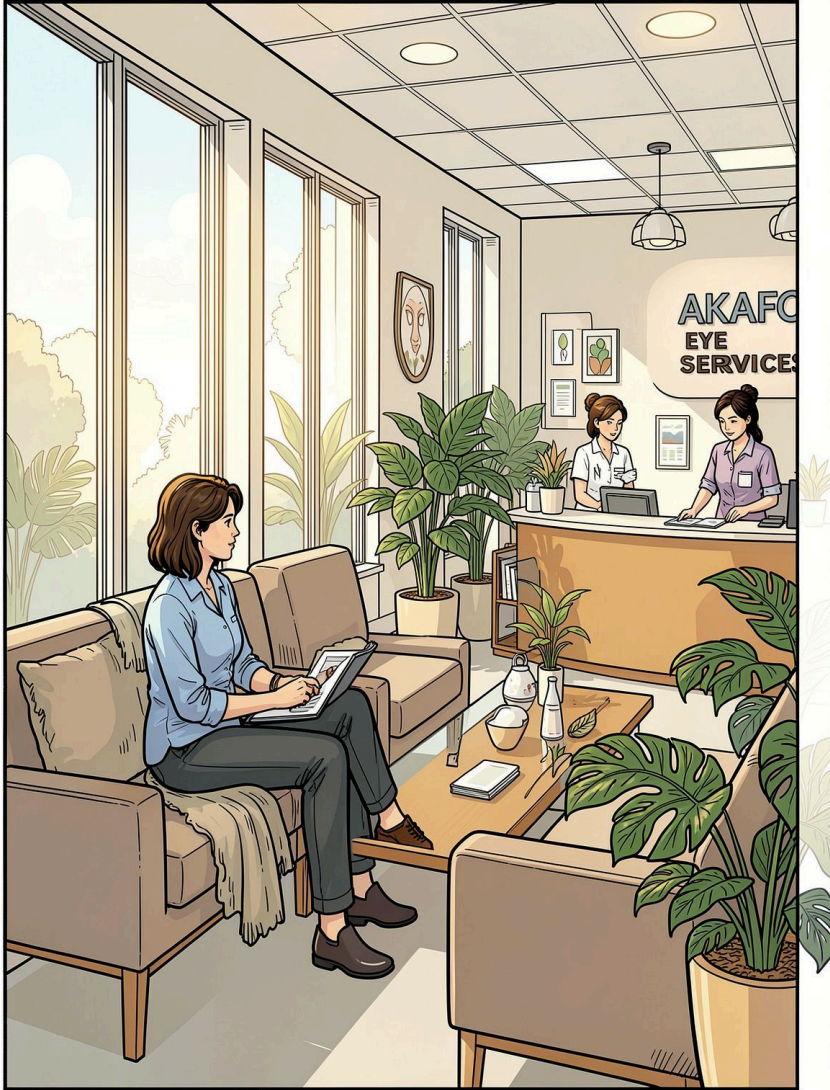
Good vision ≠ healthy eyes

Good vision today does not necessarily mean your eyes are completely healthy.

Speak up if you're at risk

If you have a family history of glaucoma, are over 40, have high eye pressure, or have concerns about your vision — talk to an eye-care professional.





Protect Your Sight — Act Today

Regular comprehensive eye examinations can help identify glaucoma before significant vision loss occurs.



Book Your Exam

Schedule a comprehensive eye examination with **Akafo Eye Services** and take an important step toward protecting your vision.



Know Your Risk

Family history, age over 40, or high eye pressure? Don't wait — speak with an eye-care professional.



This information is for educational purposes and does not replace an examination or medical advice from a qualified eye-care professional.